PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“SCHWA” /ə/ in the word “TO”

The word “to” is often pronounced as “tuh.”

If a vowel follows this word, then “to” should be pronounced as “too” or /tu/. Just as with “the,” any time you are emphasizing the “to,” you would no longer reduce it but pronounce it in its full form “too” or /tu/.

Examples:

To the store: “tuh”
To my house: “tuh”
To your client: “tuh”
To go shopping: “tuh”
To our place: “too”
To a class: “too”
To open it: “too”

Let’s practice:

according to legend
appeal to the masses
back to back
bound to happen
cater to you
come to terms with it
cut to the chase
day to day
desire to love
down to earth
drink to that
end to end
eye to eye
face to face
fall to the ground
get to go
go to my place
go to our place
have to understand
he’s dressed to the nines
head to head
hold on to your hat
hot to trot
I look forward to it
I’ll see to it
in order to get there
it boils down to this
it comes down to you
it will come to pass
it’s up to date
kept up to speed
lead to win
lean into it
learn to speak mandarin
live up to your standard
look up to you
need to get around
next to me
not to mention
on to the next
people to see
places to explore
put down to paper
read to learn more
refer to the sign
resort to jokes
right to privacy
side to side
so to speak
speak to that point
stand up to him
stick to it
straight to the point
subject to reason
thanks to you
time to time
to and fro
to begin with
to no avail
turn to your partner
up to no good
used to do it
want to understand
way to go
what to do
where to go
willing to forgive
year to date
your right to vote